

Sports Association Fingers Crossed

Members of El Paso Sports Association Inc., are keeping their fingers crossed this year. This is El Paso's sixth year back in organized baseball and the club underwriters haven't had to bail out the ball club yet.

El Paso is one of the few remaining clubs in the country owned and operated by the community on a non-profit basis.

The unique El Paso Sports Association consists of some 40 local business and professional men who underwrite the baseball operation.

A run down of the Texas League roster shows the current prevailing trend in baseball. The Amarillo Sonics are owned outright by the Houston Astro's, the Atlanta Braves own the Austin Braves, and the LA Dodgers own the Albuquerque Dodgers.

Two Texas millionaires, Tommy Mercer and Lamar Hunt own the Dallas-Fort Worth Spurs, while the St. Louis Cards set up the management for the Little Rock Travelers.

This leaves El Paso pretty much with local community ownership and management.

The 40 members of El Paso Sports Association have been a solid foundation for the ball club with very little change in the membership since it was first formed.

Some members have volunteered to put in additional time. John Phelan heads up the group as president and is the ram-rod behind the local baseball operation.

Two real working vice presi-

dents are Harry Elliott and Andy Cohen. Elliott has supervised the concession operation since the ball club started up again, and Andy Cohen has been a constant source of help on players.

El Paso started out in the class D Sophomore League in 1961. In 1962 they jumped to the Texas League and won the pennant at the same time.

The 1963 team also aroused a lot of excitement as they went on to break the Texas League home run record for a season.

Oldsters Renovate Statues

Jacksonville, Fla. (AP)—An 80-year-old building painter and his artist wife call their current project the most unusual of their lifetime.

Mr. and Mrs. Harry Edwards are renovating the statues and ornamentation at the Immaculate Conception Catholic Church here.